Mussaf Yom Tov 5783

In מוסף for the שלש רגלים, in the paragraph of וּמִפְּנֵי חֲטָאֵינוּ - one of the most inspiring and beautiful paragraphs in our davening - we say the following: יְהִי רָצוֹן מִלְּפָנֶיךָ ה׳ אֱלֹקֵינוּ וֵאלֹקֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ מָלֵךְ רַחֲמָן שָׁתָּשׁוּב וְתִתְרַחֵם עָלֵינוּ וְעַל מִקְדָּשְׁךָ בְּרַחֲמֶיךָ הָרַבִּים וְתִבְנֵהוּ מְהֵרָה וּתְגַדֵּל כְּבוֹדוֹ - We express our yearning for the return of the בית המקדש and for us to be restored to our homeland. אָבִינוּ מַלְכֵּנוּ גַּלֵּה כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתְךָ עָלֵינוּ מְהֵרָה - Please reveal to us the כבוד of your מלכות quickly. The קשיא is this seems repetitive. We already said "Let the בית המקדש return." What is being added by the next phrase, אָבִינוּ מַלְכֵּנוּ גַּלֵּה כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתְךָ עָלֵינוּ מְהֵרָה?

The כנסת ישראל machzor for Pesach brings the Vilna Gaon, who offers a fantastic vort on these פסוקים in our davening. He quotes a גמרא in חגיגה י"ג ע"ב, which says that all of the מלאכים in שמים have שֵׁשׁ כְּנָפַיִם שֵׁשׁ כְּנָפַיִם לְאֶחָד - six wings, as is brought down in ישעיהו ו׳:ב׳. However, there is another pasuk in יחזקאל א׳:ו׳ which says וְאַרְבָּעָה פָנִים לְאֶחָת, implying that they have only four wings. The גמרא asks it's a סתירה, do the מלאכים have four wings or six wings? The גמרא answers: כָּאן בִּזְמַן שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ קַיָּים, כָּאן בִּזְמַן שֶׁאֵין בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ קַיָּים - when the בית המקדש stood, the מלאכים had six wings, but when the בית המקדש was destroyed, they lost two of their wings. This is incredible. What happens in העולם הזה has enormous effects in העולם כביכול האמת.

The גמרא asks: Which two wings were lost? The גמרא brings רַב חֲנַנְאֵל אָמַר רַב who explains that the two lost wings were the middle wings, the ones used to say שירה. Since we are unable to say שירה properly in גלות, they, too, cannot say שירה. As it says (ישעיהו ו׳:ב׳ - ג׳) וּבְשָׁתַיִם יְעוֹפֵף וְקָרָא זֶה אֶל זֶה וְאָמַר. Those are the two middle wings.

The גר"א asks: What was written on those wings? He brings another מדרש that states: On those six wings it says, בָּרוּךְ שֵׁם כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד. Which words are the two middle wings? כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ. That's what we're saying in our תפילה: we are recognizing the power of our תפילה, the power of what we do here in העולם הזה. We say, אָבִינוּ מַלְכֵּנוּ גַּלֵּה כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתְךָ עָלֵינוּ מְהֵרָה הקדוש ברוך הוא - Bring back those two wings which have the words כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ, and then we will be able to serve you to our ultimate degree in the בית המקדש, במהרה בימינו.

https://youtu.be/oF1YsXeUfdg